DAY 3 | EXCEL

My Data Analyst Journey

Clipboard, Filter, Sort, Tables & Fill Series

Day 3 of learning Excel in public.

Ctrl Shift L T

Swipe to learn with me >

Clipboard Basics

Copy, cut and paste

Copy	Ctrl + C
Cut (removes from old place)	Ctrl + X
Paste (destination)	Ctrl + V
Paste Special	Ctrl + Alt + V
Windows clipboard history	Win + V
Cancel copy / cut mode	Esc

Office Clipboard: Home tab > Clipboard group arrow. It stores up to 24 copied items - click any item to paste it.

Move Data Around

Two methods, plus a few tricks

Method 1: Cut & Paste

Select > Ctrl+X (removes it from the old place) > go to destination > Ctrl+V.

Method 2: Drag

Select, then drag by the border. Ctrl+drag = copy. Shift+drag = insert between cells.

Between Sheets

Copy or cut > switch sheet with Ctrl+PgDn > paste. Sheet1 to Sheet2.

Multiple Cells

Ctrl+Click cells, then Ctrl+C. Works only if the selection lines up in the same rows or columns.

Filter

Ctrl + Shift + L

The Idea

Dirty water > Filter > clean water. Messy data > Filter > only what you need.

How It Works

Master data has North, South, East, West. Filter North and the other rows hide.

Filter vs Conditional Formatting

Filter hides other data. Conditional Formatting shows all data and only highlights.

Filter by Color

Filter rows by their highlight color.

Filter & Sort Shortcuts

Do it without the mouse

Turn filter on / off	Ctrl + Shift + L
Open filter dropdown	Alt + Down
Clear filter	Alt + A + C
Reapply filter	Ctrl + Alt + L
Sort A to Z (smallest first)	Alt + A + S + A
Sort Z to A (largest first)	Alt + A + S + D
Custom Sort (many levels)	Alt + A + S + S

Filter dropdowns also have a search box plus Text, Number and Date filters. Key tips can vary by Excel version - press Alt to check.

Sorting

Arrange your data

Text

A to Z or Z to A.

Date

Oldest to Newest or Newest to Oldest.

Number

Ascending = smallest to largest. Descending = largest to smallest.

Sort by Color

Like filter by color, but nothing is hidden.

Custom Sort

Sort by many levels, e.g. Department first, then Sales largest to smallest.

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Normal Data vs Table

Why Ctrl + T is worth it

	Normal Data	Excel Table
Data growth	Fixed range	**Auto-expands**
Formatting	Manual	**Automatic**
Formulas	Not dynamic	**Dynamic**
Extra tab	None	**Table Design**
Filtering	Filter only	**Filter + Slicer**
Referencing	A1:A10	**[@Salary] names**
Totals	Manual AutoSum	**Total Row**

Create a Table

Three ways to make one

Select all your data	Ctrl + A
Create table (shortcut)	Ctrl + T
Insert > Table	Alt + N + T
Show / hide Total Row	Ctrl + Shift + T
Convert table to range	Alt + J + T + G
Clear all cell colors	Alt + H + H + N

Or: Home > Format as Table. My Table Has Headers checked = first row is the header. Unchecked = Excel adds a Column1, Column2 header row.

Table Design Tab

Click inside the table to see it

Header Row

Show or hide the header row.

Total Row

Adds a total row at the bottom with built-in functions for each column.

First / Last Column

Makes the first or last column bold.

Banded Rows / Columns

Alternating row or column shading.

Table Name

Top-left corner. Give it a clear name like SalesData (no spaces).

Dynamic Tables & Slicer

Tables grow by themselves

Auto Expansion

Add rows or columns and the table, formulas and formatting grow automatically.

Structured Reference

Formulas use names like [@Salary] instead of cell addresses like B2.

Slicer

Table Design > Insert Slicer. Click buttons to filter. Ctrl+Click picks several.

Back to Normal

Table Design > Tools > Convert to Range > OK.

Table Limitations

Know the downsides

Formula Autofill

A formula fills the whole column, which you may not want.

Different References

Formulas show [@Salary], not B2.

No Merged Cells

Merged cells are not allowed inside a table.

Custom Layouts

Reports or print layouts may need extra adjusting.

Converting Back

Going back to a normal range takes extra steps.

Fill Series

Fill cells without typing

Fill Series dialog box — Alt + H + F + I + S

Fill down — Ctrl + D

Fill right — Ctrl + R

Fill up — Alt + H + F + I + U

Fill left — Alt + H + F + I + L

Or: Home > Editing > Fill > Series. Choose Rows or Columns, the type (Linear, Growth, Date), a Step value and a Stop value, then OK.

Linear vs Growth

Add or subtract, multiply or divide

`Linear: 1, step 2`	1, 3, 5, 7 ...
`Linear: 15, step -3`	15, 12, 9, 6, 3
`Growth: 2, step 2`	2, 4, 8, 16, 32
`Growth: 10000, step 0.1`	10000, 1000, 100, 10, 1

Linear adds or subtracts. Growth only multiplies, so to divide by 10 use the decimal step 0.1. A step of 10 would multiply by 10 instead. Always set a Stop value.

SEQUENCE Function

Dynamic number grids

`=SEQUENCE(10)` — 1 to 10 down a column

`=SEQUENCE(5,5,1,5)` — 5x5 grid, step 5

Syntax: =SEQUENCE(rows, columns, start, step). Press Enter and the numbers spill out automatically. Available in Excel 365 and 2021 or newer.

Dates & Time

Enter and fill dates fast

Ctrl ;

Insert today's date (stays fixed). Use =TODAY() for a live date.

Ctrl Shift ;

Insert the current time.

Fill Series: Day / Weekday

Day adds 1 day. Weekday skips Saturday and Sunday.

Fill Series: Month / Year

Month steps by month (31-05-2026, 30-06-2026, 31-07-2026 ...). Year steps by year.

Day 3
Done!

Clipboard, filter, sort, tables
and fill series.

Do you use Excel Tables or normal ranges?
Tell me in the comments.

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